

South Africa — Foreign-born

Data extract and provenance sheet · retrieved 2026-08-17 · Migration and Population Data Archive

Values

Year	Value	Grade	Verification	Source	Reference date
2010	2,274,466	A	reproduced exactly from the live source	UN DESA International Migrant Stock (World Bank indicator SM.POP.TOTL)	Mid-year / 30 June
2011	2,184,408	C	modelled estimate; not mechanically re-derivable	Statistics South Africa - Census 2011 (as tabulated in the Census 2022 Statistical Release	1 October (census)
2015	3,162,564	A	reproduced exactly from the live source	UN DESA International Migrant Stock (World Bank indicator SM.POP.TOTL)	Mid-year / 30 June
2016	1,578,541	C	modelled estimate; not mechanically re-derivable	Statistics South Africa - Community Survey 2016 (presented to the UN Expert Forum on Inter	Census reference date
2020	2,639,076	A	reproduced exactly from the live source	UN DESA International Migrant Stock (World Bank indicator SM.POP.TOTL)	Mid-year / 30 June
2022	2,418,197	C	modelled estimate; not mechanically re-derivable	Statistics South Africa - Census 2022 Statistical Release P0301.4	Census reference date

Definition note. UN estimate (not annual); mid-year benchmark year only; retrieved from World Bank mirror of UN DESA International Migrant Stock, accessed 2026-08

Source URL(s)

- https://api.worldbank.org/v2/country/CHN;IND;PHL;RUS;ZAF;SUR;THA/indicator/SM.POP.TOTL?format=json&date=2010:2022&per_page=200
- https://census.statssa.gov.za/assets/documents/2022/P03014_Census_2022_Statistical_Release.pdf
- <https://unstats.un.org/unsd/demographic-social/migrationstat-forum-2023/presentations/E.3/4.Itani-StatsSA.pdf>

Archived evidence files

- [evidence/api/publisher_pages/worldbank_SM_POP_TOTL.pdf](#)
- [evidence/api/publisher_pages/worldbank_SM_POP_TOTL.png](#)
- [evidence/api/wb_SM_POP_TOTL.json](#)
- [evidence/countries/ZAF/foreign_born__c204ed0e2a__census.statssa.gov.za.pdf](#)
- [evidence/countries/ZAF/foreign_born__a8ebe1b51a__unstats.un.org.pdf](#)

Grades: A re-derived from a machine-readable official source and matched exactly, or corrected against one during verification · B confirmed by reading the retrieved source document · C source document retrieved but the value is a modelled estimate · D cited source could not be retrieved.

Joint work of Prof. Raymond Kuo, National Taiwan University, and Claude (Anthropic).